

SNEAK PEEKS



2002

THE HOTTEST GAMES OF



PC gaming is back with a bang and guarantees to make this year one big head rush

Without a doubt, gaming consoles dominated 2001. With the Xbox, Gamecube and the PlayStation 2 garnering most of the attention, PC gaming took a back seat. While titles such as *Return to Castle Wolfenstein*, *Commandos II* and *Max Payne* made some noise, for the most part 2001 was a pretty quiet year for PC gamers. Older heroes such as *Counter-Strike*, *Red Alert II* and *Quake III* continued with their domination of gaming.

With the hype around the game boxes finally behind us, the spotlight is shifting back to the PC platform. As online gaming continues to gain popularity worldwide, we can expect most of the games to include single and multiplayer action. *Medal of*

Honor: Allied Assault made the first draw by coming out in January. Get ready for 2002: the year is chock-full of gaming action.

AGE OF WONDERS II

Fans of real-time strategy games are in for a real treat. *Age of Wonders II* (AoW II) packs in even more role-playing components than the previous version. Not only does the title feature totally revamped graphics that boast some radical visuals, it also adds a random map generator and enhanced audio that go a long way in enticing you to play the game over and over again.

AoW II's terrain is incredibly detailed and certain elements such as new and tougher character races have been added to make gameplay more challenging. But the most impressive trait

